PADHAKU
Kaveri · Class 9 English

CHAPTER 7

Carrier of Words

NCERT Exercise Solutions

Carrier of Words · Reflect and Respond 7 Q

Carrier of Words · Check Your Understanding (I) 3 Q

Carrier of Words · Check Your Understanding (II) 3 Q

Carrier of Words · Critical Reflection 15 Q

Carrier of Words · Vocabulary and Structures in Context 7 Q

Carrier of Words · Listen and Respond 6 Q

Carrier of Words · Speaking Activity 1 Q

Carrier of Words · Writing Task 1 Q

Carrier of Words · Learning Beyond the Text 2 Q

Words · Reflect and Respond 2 Q

Words · Check Your Understanding 17 Q

Words · Critical Reflection 15 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.
Unofficial student study guide for Kaveri Class 9 English. Not from official NCERT publication.

⭐ Carrier of Words · Reflect and Respond

I 1 **Look at the pictures of persons engaged in the same profession. Which profession do they belong to?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

They are **postmen** (postal workers of India Post) who deliver letters and parcels.

I 2 **Do they face any difficulties while doing their duty?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes. They walk long distances in heat, rain and cold, carry heavy mailbags, and reach places with poor roads.

I 3 **How does their profession affect the people they meet?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

They bring news, letters, money orders and parcels. People feel connected to their families, so postmen are trusted and welcomed.

II 1 **How can ‘words’ be ‘carried’?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Words can be carried in letters, postcards, telegrams, messages, emails and phone calls.

II 2 **Who could be a carrier of words?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

A postman, a messenger, a courier, or even a friend who passes on a message.

II 3 **What are the means for people to stay connected?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Letters, postcards, phone calls, text messages, emails, video calls and social media.

III **Fill in the passage with: slumped, dunes, defying, hamlets, signals, devoid.**
...our body sent 1. ___ that our decision to visit the sand 2. ___ ... We had passed a few 3. ___ ... not a single soul outdoors, 4. ___ the blazing sun. Even the camels were 5. ___ in the little shade ... the area was 6. ___ of any other network service.

✔ **ANSWER**

1. **signals**
2. **dunes**
3. **hamlets**
4. **defying**

5. **slumped**
6. **devoid**

Carrier of Words · Check Your Understanding (I)

I **Fill up the information sheet for Khetaram's identity card.**

Name: Khetaram

Position / Employer / Official address / Mode of transport used / Key responsibilities

✔ ANSWER

Field	Details
Name	Khetaram
Position	Gramin Dak Sewak (sole postman)
Employer	India Post (Department of Posts, Government of India)
Official address	Somarad Branch Post Office, near Barmer, Rajasthan (2.5 km from the Indo-Pakistan border)
Mode of transport used	On foot (sometimes a lift from the BSF)

Key responsibilities:

- Delivering mail to far-flung hamlets (dhaanis) within 24 hours of dispatch from Jodhpur
- Carrying the mailbag (up to 28 kilos) across sand dunes
- Reading out letters and writing replies for villagers

- Delivering money orders and the BSF camp's dak

II 1 **Why do you think Khetaram has taken up this challenging job?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Famine is common there and one crop of bajra cannot feed his family of five. The job gives him an assured income; he also likes serving the people.

II 2 **How do you think Khetaram would feel about taking up this challenging task every day?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

He would feel tired in the heat, but also proud and happy that he serves people and is trusted by them. He says, “Main tayyar hoon” (I’m ready).

⭐ Carrier of Words · Check Your Understanding (II)

I **Complete the table: situations (Column 1) and reasons (Column 2).**

1. ___ → When the temperature is recorded as 50 °C and above, a state holiday has to be declared.

2. Khetaram can dwell on any threshold. → ___

3. BSF always gave Khetaram a lift. → ___

✔ ANSWER

1. **The temperature is recorded as 49.9 °C even when it has crossed 50 °C.**
2. **Because people trust him; he is a warmly received man who reads out their letters and writes replies.**
3. **Because people are kind to him and he distributes the dak (mail) of the BSF camp.**

II **Why was a piece of jaggery offered in the village when he brought news of a birth or weddings?**

✔ ANSWER

The villagers were poor; a piece of jaggery was all they could offer. It was a sweet way to celebrate the good news and thank him.

III **How would phone lines help Khetaram in his job?**

✔ ANSWER

He might become a Gramin Sanchar Sewak and carry a cell phone along with the post. People could talk to their families directly and he could serve them better.

⭐ Carrier of Words · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **"Akaal or famine is a way of life here..." Complete: One crop of bajra makes a little difference for people like Khetaram because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

because **it cannot feed a family of five / it is not enough to live on for the whole year.**

I 1 (ii) **Why did Khetaram term famine as 'a way of life'?**

✔ ANSWER

Because famine happens so often in this dry (arid) land that people have to live with it regularly.

I 1 (iii) **Give one reason why Khetaram had to take up a job to help his family to survive.**

✔ ANSWER

Even in a good year he gets only one crop of bajra, which cannot feed his family of five.

I 1 (iv) **Complete the analogy: Other families : Money orders :: Khetaram : ___**

✔ ANSWER

job (other families survive on money orders; Khetaram survives on his job).

I 1 (v) **What would ‘a good year’ signify?**

✔ ANSWER

A year with enough rain, when at least one crop of bajra can grow.

I 2 (i) **Who could have torn the right corner of the envelope?**

A. Khetaram B. Sender of the letter C. Receiver of the letter D. The postmaster

✔ ANSWER

B. Sender of the letter – the sender tears the corner to signal that the letter carries news of death.

I 2 (ii) **Complete: The most likely reason for Khetaram reading the letter twice is because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

because **he wanted the family to hear and understand the sad news clearly, as he would tear the letter afterwards and could not take it into the house.**

I 2 (iii) **What was Khetaram's philosophy regarding bad news, and how did he act upon it?**

✔ ANSWER

He believed "bad news must be destroyed" and cannot be carried into the house. So he stood outside, read the letter aloud twice and then tore it to bits.

I 2 (iv) **True or false: Khetaram's action of tearing the letter differed from his beliefs.**

✔ ANSWER

False. Tearing the letter matched his belief that bad news must be destroyed.

I 2 (v) **Mention any one aspect of Khetaram's temperament revealed through this extract.**

✔ ANSWER

He is sensitive and respectful of people's feelings and local beliefs (also philosophical).

II 1 **Justify the statement of the Postmaster-General, Rajasthan Western Region, that the role of GDS is 'invaluable'.**

✔ ANSWER

GDS deliver mail in interior areas that are often unreachable by any means except on foot – deserts, islands and riverine areas. They are the sole link between these remote people and their families, and they form more than 50 per cent of the postal workforce.

II 2 **How was the purpose of India Post different from that of the British postal system?**

✔ ANSWER

The British system was set up to relay company dak between administrative centres. After independence, India Post aimed to bring the entire population within the mailing ambit (post offices grew from 25,000 in 1947 to more than 1.5 lakh).

II 3 **People trusted Gramin Dak Sewaks. Support this statement with any two instances from the text.**

✔ ANSWER

- Rural depositors entrust their monthly savings to the post office through the GDS.
- Villagers ask Khetaram to read out their letters and draft replies; he can dwell on any threshold.

- A plan to give the GDS job to patwaris was rejected: “We knew they would not be able to do the job.”

II 4 **Infer the most likely reason that Khetaram was grateful to continue as GDS, even after the age of 60.**

✔ ANSWER

The job gives him an assured income for his family (farming alone cannot feed them), and he can keep serving the people he loves.

II 5 **Explain why the author pays tribute to people like Khetaram.**

✔ ANSWER

They work in very hard conditions – heat, sandstorms, long walks – to connect remote people with their families. They are part of our social fabric and a great support, so they deserve our salute.

⭐ Carrier of Words · Vocabulary and Structures in Context

I **Match the phrases with their meanings.**

1. crumbles into sand 2. give a new lease of life 3. turn into a trickle before drying out 4. bearing words across this desolate geography

(i) get a chance to continue living (ii) carrying letters to less populated areas (iii) disappears in the desert (iv) lessen gradually and then finally stop

✔ ANSWER

1 – **(iii)**

2 – **(i)**

3 – **(iv)**

4 – **(ii)**

I (sentences) **Use the phrases from Column 1 in sentences of your own.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. The village road crumbles into sand a few kilometres after the school.

2. The new medicine gave my grandfather a new lease of life.

3. In May, the stream turns into a trickle before drying out.

4. The postman has spent years bearing words across this desolate geography.

II **Identify examples of alliteration and metaphor: "Khetaram's khaki turban and uniform are his only protection against the desert's furies, the scorching summer winds and swirling sandstorms which turn him into a walking sandman."**

✔ ANSWER

Alliteration: "Khetaram's khaki" (k sound), "scorching summer", "swirling sandstorms ... sandman" (s sound).

Metaphor: "a walking sandman" – Khetaram, covered in sand, is called a sandman. ("the desert's furies" also compares the harsh weather to angry beings.)

III **Match the words with what they suggest in the context of the chapter.**

1. arid 2. concessional 3. gaunt 4. remote 5. desolate

(i) interest rate for the farmers (ii) corner of the world (iii) farmland without much yield (iv) desert stretching far and wide (v) farmer waiting for the rains

✔ ANSWER

1 – **(iii)**

2 – **(i)**

3 – **(v)**

4 – **(ii)**

5 – **(iv)**

III (sentences) **Use the words from Column 1 in sentences of your own.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. Little grows on this arid land.
2. The bank gave the farmers loans at a concessional rate.
3. The gaunt farmer looked at the dry sky.
4. Khetaram serves a remote village near the border.
5. The desolate desert had no house for miles.

IV **Fill in the blanks with the present perfect form of the verbs.**

1. I ___ (has/have) just ___ (get) a collection of postage stamps from my grandfather. He 2. ___ (collect) these stamps over 20 years. I 3. ___ (study) most of the stamps... I 4. ___ (begin) my own collection. Grandfather 5. ___ truly ___ (inspire) me.

✔ ANSWER

1. **have**, **got**
2. **has collected**
3. **have studied**
4. **have begun**
5. **has** truly **inspired**

V 3 **Complete the paragraph about Khetaram's advice in the passive voice.**

To begin with, a lot of stamina will be needed for this job. Next, reading clearly A. ___, as you B. ___ to read out the letters by some of the villagers. Words C. ___ neatly as you D. ___ to draft replies by some villagers. Full-sleeved shirts and trousers E. ___ to protect yourself from the heat.

✔ ANSWER

A. **should be practised**

B. **will be expected**

C. **should be written**

D. **will be asked**

E. **should be worn**

⭐ Carrier of Words · Listen and Respond

I **The speaker concluded her talk with a ___. (suggestion/request/advice)**

✔ ANSWER

request – "I request all the students to actively participate..."

II 1 What was the occasion that the speaker was talking about? (i) Letter writing carnival (ii) Philately day (iii) Indian Postal Day

✔ ANSWER

(iii) Indian Postal Day (celebrated on 10 October).

II 2 India Post is famous for having the most extensive network ___. (i) in India (ii) in the world (iii) among design institutes

✔ ANSWER

(ii) in the world

II 3 Letter writing is being revived as this art form has been ___. (i) celebrated (ii) appreciated (iii) forgotten

✔ ANSWER

(iii) forgotten

II 4 Which of the following will be a part of the letter writing carnival? (i) calligraphy and graphology (ii) origami and designing (iii) letter posting and philately

✔ ANSWER

(i) calligraphy and graphology

II 5 **What will the postal department add to the event? (i) interactive demonstrations (ii) theatre and dance (iii) workshop for letter writing**

✔ ANSWER

(i) interactive demonstrations

Carrier of Words · Speaking Activity

I **Postcard, inland letter, envelope and money order form discuss who is the most important. In groups of four, take one each and give reasons (utility, cost effective, privacy, space to write, possibility of enclosures).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Postcard: It seems to me that I am the most cost effective. Anyone can buy me for a few rupees and send a quick message.

Inland letter: I would like to point out that I give more space to write than a postcard, and my message is folded and private.

Envelope: That's one way to look at it, but only I can carry enclosures like photos, documents and cards, and I keep everything private.

Money order form: Some people say letters matter most, but I carry money to families in remote villages. Many families survive because of me.

Conclusion: I totally agree that each of us is useful in its own way.

⭐ Carrier of Words · Writing Task

I **On behalf of your parents, draft an imaginary condolence message for your aunt on the recent passing away of her father.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

12 March 20XX

Dear Sunita Didi,

We are deeply saddened to hear about the passing away of your father, Shri Ramesh Chandra ji. Please accept our heartfelt condolences.

He was a kind and gentle person, and we will always remember his warmth and his blessings. We extend our deepest sympathy to you and the whole family in this hour of grief.

May God give eternal peace to the departed soul and give you and the family the strength and courage to bear this great loss.

Yours sincerely,

Rakesh and Meena

📘 Carrier of Words · Learning Beyond the Text

II 1 **Study the postage stamps given and discuss who or what they depict.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Sarojini Naidu** (1879–1949) – poet and freedom fighter
- **Kishore Kumar** – famous singer and actor
- **Teej** – festival celebrated by women (dancing under a tree, moon in the sky)
- **Painted Stork** – a bird (nature)
- **Sun Temple, Konark** – heritage monument in Odisha

II 2 **Work in groups of five. Find information about stamps on personalities, celebrations, centenaries, nature and our heritage, and prepare a class board on 'Philately– Upholding Our Heritage'.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Category	Example	Details
Personalities	Sarojini Naidu	Poet, freedom fighter (the Nightingale of India)
Celebrations	Teej / Republic Day	Festival of monsoon / national event

Centenaries	Mahatma Gandhi's birth centenary (1969)	Honours the Father of the Nation
Nature	Painted Stork / Tiger	Shows India's wildlife
Our heritage	Sun Temple, Konark; Kathak	Monument / classical dance

Paste pictures of the stamps with these notes on the class board.

⭐ Words · Reflect and Respond

I **Why are words important? Can we communicate without words? How?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Words help us share ideas, feelings and information clearly. Yes, we can also communicate without words – through gestures, facial expressions, body language, signs, pictures and sign language.

II **Find words from the grid to fill the blanks (example: My mother summoned me...).**

Horizontal: 1. We eat food to ___ our hunger. 2. The train will ___ from the station at 5.00 p.m. 3. The gardener was removing the ___ to clean the flower beds.

Vertical: 4. The view from the top of the hill was ___ the difficult climb. 5. The herbs and spices ___ flavour to food. 6. Flowers ___ in

spring. 7. We enjoyed a delicious ___ after the ceremony.

✔ ANSWER

1. **satisfy**
2. **depart**
3. **weeds**
4. **worth**
5. **impart**
6. **blossom**
7. **feast**

⭐ Words · Check Your Understanding

I **Fill in the blanks with one word from the poem.**

Words are compared to summer birds who 1. ___ ... The heart is equated to a 2. ___ who finds that words are as worthless as 3. ___ ... a few sincere words can bring more 4. ___ than many ... a voice that brings happiness to a 5. ___ place ... the 6. ___ would celebrate ... like a 7. ___ .

✔ ANSWER

1. **depart**
2. **pilgrim**
3. **weeds**
4. **joy**
5. **lonely**

6. **world**
7. **fruit**

II 1 **Find any four sets of rhyming words and write the rhyme scheme of the poem.**

✔ ANSWER

Rhyming words: heart – depart, care – air, earth – worth, needs – weeds, said – head, impart – heart, way – say, cheer – dear, chest – test, feast – least, show – grow, root – fruit.

Rhyme scheme: **abab** in every stanza.

II 2 (i) **Identify the poetic device and explain: "But words, like summer birds, depart..."**

✔ ANSWER

Simile. Words are compared to summer birds that fly away – words do not last; they leave quickly and leave nothing behind.

II 2 (ii) **"heart, a pilgrim upon earth..."**

✔ ANSWER

Metaphor. The heart is called a pilgrim – it travels through life searching for true meaning and comfort.

II 2 (iii) **"words are of as little worth / As just so many weeds"**

✔ ANSWER

Simile. Words are compared to weeds – empty words are useless and of no value when we need them.

II 2 (iv) **"If words could satisfy the chest ... Oft satisfy the least!"**

✔ ANSWER

Contrast (antithesis). The poet contrasts what words could do with what they really do – words promise much but often satisfy the least.

II 2 (v) **"The world might hold a feast..."**

✔ ANSWER

Hyperbole. The whole world celebrating is an exaggeration – it shows how happy people would be if words truly satisfied them.

II 2 (vi) **"Like plants that make a gaudy show / All blossom to the root"**

✔ ANSWER

Simile (with hyperbole in “all blossom to the root”). Many showy words are like plants full of bright flowers – they look impressive but have no substance.

II 2 (vii) **“But whose poor nature cannot grow / One particle of fruit!”**

✔ ANSWER

Metaphor. Empty words are like plants that cannot produce even one fruit – they bring no real result or benefit.

II 3 **Which words are repeated in the poem? Why does the poet use repetition?**

✔ ANSWER

‘Words’, ‘heart’ and ‘satisfy’ are repeated (also ‘If words could satisfy…’). Repetition stresses the main idea – words often fail to satisfy the heart – and gives the poem rhythm.

II 4 **Stanzas 4, 5 and 6 end with exclamation marks. Choose the emotions expressed.**

(i) 4. disillusionment 5. admiration 6. frustration

(ii) 4. frustration 5. admiration 6. disillusionment

(iii) 4. admiration 5. frustration 6. disillusionment

(iv) 4. frustration 5. disillusionment 6. admiration

✔ ANSWER

(iii) – Stanza 4 (“But, oh! those few, how dear!”) shows admiration for a few sincere words; stanza 5 (“Oft satisfy the least!”) shows frustration; stanza 6 (“One particle of fruit!”) shows disillusionment.

III **Identify examples of hyperbole: “If words could satisfy the chest, / The world might hold a feast.”**

✔ ANSWER

Hyperbole: “The world might hold a feast” – the whole world holding a feast is an exaggeration.

III 1 **I have ___ things to do on this weekend. (lots of/tonnes of)**

✔ ANSWER

I have **tonnes of** things to do on this weekend.

III 2 **The player missed the basket by ___. (a mile/an inch)**

✔ ANSWER

The player missed the basket by **a mile**.

III 3 **My mother is so tired that she can sleep for a ___. (night/decade)**

✔ ANSWER

My mother is so tired that she can sleep for a **decade**.

III 4 **I will be back in ___. (five minutes/two seconds)**

✔ ANSWER

I will be back in **two seconds**.

IV **Listen to the teacher read the poem and mark the stressed syllables in all the lines.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The poem follows a regular beat: unstressed–stressed (da-DUM), four beats in lines 1 and 3, three beats in lines 2 and 4 of each stanza. Stressed syllables in CAPITALS, e.g.:

The HEART, a PILgrim UPon EARTH,

Finds OFten, WHEN it NEEDS,

That WORDS are OF as LITtle WORTH

As JUST so MAny WEEDS.

A LITtle SAID, and TRULy SAID,

Can DEEPer JOY imPART

Than HOSTS of WORDS, which REACH the HEAD,

But NEVer TOUCH the HEART.

⭐ Words · Critical Reflection

I 1 (i) **Why has the poet referred to the heart as 'a pilgrim'?**

✔ ANSWER

Because the heart travels through life, like a pilgrim on a holy journey, searching for true feelings, comfort and meaning.

I 1 (ii) **When would a heart 'need' words?**

✔ ANSWER

In times of sorrow, loneliness or deep emotion – when it wants comfort or wants to express its true feelings.

I 1 (iii) **Complete: The words are like weeds because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

because **they are many but useless; they have no real value when the heart needs them.**

I 1 (iv) **Mention two emotions the heart might be experiencing when it finds words to be of 'little worth'.**

✔ ANSWER

Disappointment and loneliness (also sadness/helplessness).

I 1 (v) **What do these lines suggest about the nature of communication?**

✔ ANSWER

Real communication is not about many words; words often fail to express deep feelings. Sincerity and feeling matter more.

I 2 (i) **How can words 'satisfy the chest'?**

✔ ANSWER

When they are sincere and come from the heart, they can truly comfort a person and fulfil the feelings inside.

I 2 (ii) **How can words be 'summoned to the test'?**

✔ ANSWER

When they are put to use in a real situation – when someone needs comfort or help, or when promises must be kept.

I 2 (iii) **What does ‘the world’ holding ‘a feast’ imply?**

✔ ANSWER

Everyone would be happy and celebrate, because words alone would fulfil all their needs.

I 2 (iv) **Complete: The poet mentions that words satisfy the least because ___.**

✔ ANSWER

because **words are often empty and are not backed by true feeling or action.**

I 2 (v) **Select the word that does not mean the same as ‘oft’. A. always B. usually C. frequently D. often**

✔ ANSWER

A. always – ‘oft’ means often, not always.

II 1 **What is the comparison that the poet draws between words and ‘empty air’?**

✔ ANSWER

Words are like summer birds that fly away and leave only empty air – they pass quickly and leave nothing lasting behind.

II 2 **According to the poet, meaningful words are more precious than a lot of them. Explain.**

✔ ANSWER

"A little said, and truly said" gives deeper joy than "hosts of words" that reach only the head. A voice that cheers a lonely home says only a few words, but those few are very dear.

II 3 **Do you agree that the poet presents contrasting ideas related to 'words' in the poem? Why?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes. He says many words are empty, like weeds, birds that depart or plants with no fruit. But he also says a few sincere words are precious and bring deep joy. So words can be worthless or very valuable, depending on sincerity.

II 4 **The theme of loneliness hovers over the poem. Support this statement with examples.**

✔ ANSWER

- Words depart and "leave but empty air".
- The heart is "a pilgrim upon earth", travelling alone and finding words worthless.

- "A lonely home to cheer" – a voice brings comfort to a lonely place.

II 5 **How does the poet convey the superficial nature of words? What ought to be done to address this?**

✔ ANSWER

He compares empty words to weeds, to summer birds that depart and to gaudy plants that blossom but bear no fruit. To address this, we should speak less and speak truly – use sincere words that touch the heart and are backed by action.

⭐ Words · Vocabulary in Context

I **Match the phrases with their meanings.**

1. satisfy the heart 2. depart and leave but empty air 3. hosts of words 4. never touch the heart 5. wins its sunny way 6. plants that cannot grow fruit

(i) many words (ii) cheers up a person (iii) there is no outcome (iv) makes one happy (v) does not appeal to our emotions (vi) makes no impact

✔ ANSWER

1 – **(iv)**

2 – **(vi)**

3 – **(i)**

4 – **(v)**

5 – **(ii)**

6 – **(iii)**

I (sentences) **Use each phrase in a sentence of your own.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. Her kind letter satisfied my heart.
2. His big promises departed and left but empty air.
3. The speech had hosts of words but little meaning.
4. Long lectures without feeling never touch the heart.
5. Grandmother's smile wins its sunny way into everyone's mood.
6. Plans without hard work are plants that cannot grow fruit.

II **Create a 'Word Map' for: depart, pilgrim, sunny, satisfy, heart, word (meaning, synonym, antonym, sentence, sketch). (cheer is done)**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

depart – Meaning: to go away / leave. Synonym: leave. Antonym: arrive. Sentence: The bus will depart at 6 a.m. Sketch: a bird flying away.

pilgrim – Meaning: a person who travels to a holy place. Synonym: traveller, devotee. Antonym: resident (one who stays). Sentence: Many pilgrims visit Kedarnath every year. Sketch: a person with a stick walking on a path.

sunny – Meaning: bright with sunshine; cheerful. Synonym: bright, cheerful. Antonym: gloomy, cloudy. Sentence: She has a sunny nature. Sketch: a smiling sun.

satisfy – Meaning: to fulfil a need or wish. Synonym: please, fulfil. Antonym: disappoint. Sentence: A glass of water satisfied my thirst. Sketch: a smiling face after a meal.

heart – Meaning: the organ that pumps blood; the centre of feelings. Synonym: soul, core. Antonym: mind/head (feeling vs. thinking). Sentence: She spoke from her heart. Sketch: a heart shape.

word – Meaning: a unit of language that has meaning. Synonym: term, expression. Antonym: silence. Sentence: Choose your words carefully. Sketch: a speech bubble.

⭐ Words · Listen and Respond

I **Mark four statements that are true.**

1. The girl was excited to participate in the declamation contest.

2. The boy was doubtful about the suitability of the topic chosen for the contest.

3. The girl explained that people prefer to keep their personal experiences to themselves.

4. The boy was unaware of the role played by body language in reflecting the speaker's confidence.

5. According to the girl, body language had an insignificant role to play in communication.

6. The girl had issued the book on body language earlier from the library.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

True: **1, 2, 4 and 6**.

1 – she was among the first to register; 2 – he asked, "Do you think it is a topic that can lead to an engaging talk?"; 4 – he asked, "Body language? How?"; 6 – she knew the books are in the reference section (most likely answer).

3 is false (people want to share their experiences); 5 is false (she says to work on body language).

🧪 Words · Speaking Activity

I **Select the quotation you like most, explain it and share the reason for your choice.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

I chose Gautama Buddha's quotation, "Whatever words we utter should be chosen with care for people will hear them and be influenced by them for good or ill," because words have great power.

It means that our words can lift someone up or hurt them deeply, so we must think before we speak.

Once, a few kind words from my teacher before an exam gave me the confidence to do well. Since then, I try to speak kindly to others.

⭐ Words · Writing Task

I **Write an essay on any one quotation from the speaking activity (Introduction; two body paragraphs; counterargument; conclusion).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Choose Your Words with Care

Gautama Buddha said, "Whatever words we utter should be chosen with care for people will hear them and be influenced by them for good or ill." This quotation appeals to me because I have seen how a single sentence can change someone's day. In this essay, I will explain why our words matter so much.

Words shape the feelings of others. A word of praise can make a shy student confident, while a harsh remark can make someone lose hope. For instance, when a teacher says “Well done” to a struggling child, the child often works harder. Kind words build trust and friendship.

In addition to affecting others, words also show who we are. People judge us by how we speak. Consequently, a person who speaks politely and truthfully earns respect, while one who uses careless or rude words loses it. Words once spoken cannot be taken back, so they must be chosen thoughtfully.

Some may argue that actions matter more than words, and that speaking carefully is less important than doing good work. However, this criticism is weak, because words often come before actions – they encourage, guide and inspire people to act. Careless words can also undo the good of many kind actions.

Finally, Buddha’s advice reminds us that words carry great power for good or ill. By choosing them with care, we can spread kindness and confidence around us. Let us think before we speak, for our words may stay in someone’s heart forever.

📘 Words · Learning Beyond the Text

I **In groups of six, play the ‘Non-verbal’ game: write/draw an expression on one slip and a**

gesture on another, pick slips in turns and enact them in 30 seconds; the first to identify gets 10 points.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Example slips – Expressions: happy, tired, surprised, angry, worried. Gestures: thumbs-up (well done), finger on lips (keep quiet), waving (goodbye), holding hands together (united), shrugging (I don't know).

Play two rounds, add the points and announce the Non-verbal Champion.

🎉 **Chapter 7 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**